

Afton Gauntlett, Frontend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Frontend engineer with six years of professional experience in design systems, accessible UI, and component architecture. Led an Angular-to-React migration, built a multi-theme Storybook design system, and shipped production tooling at Booz Allen Hamilton — earning three internal awards and a spot representing the team at AWS re:Invent.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

TypeScript • JavaScript • React • Next.js • Astro • Vue • Tailwind CSS • Framer Motion • GSAP • Storybook • TanStack Query • Playwright • Jest • Figma • Design Systems • WCAG • Section 508 • Supabase • PostgreSQL • Vercel • Git • GitHub Copilot • Claude

EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton

Lead Engineer

03/2023 - 05/2025

- Built and maintained a Storybook component library and multi-theme design system adopted across multiple production React applications, reducing redundant UI work and establishing shared patterns the whole team shipped from.
- Designed and delivered a stepper-driven data portal in close collaboration with stakeholders — using interactive prototypes to win buy-in over a competing proposal on a high-value contract.
- Identified and scoped an opportunity for a secure LLM-powered chatbot, coordinated with MLOps to stand up the low-side environment, and owned the frontend interface and UX polish from prototype through production.

Software Engineer

03/2022 - 03/2023

- Led an Angular-to-React migration focused on UI structure, component reuse, and long-term maintainability — establishing the design system and design workflows the team still uses.
- Owned Section 508 compliance across production applications, authoring shared accessibility standards and patterns that made interfaces usable by default.
- Introduced Prettier, ESLint, Husky, and TanStack Query — modernizing the frontend toolchain and shifting the team from class-based to functional components.
- Supported QA team with smoke test authoring and test documentation; trained testers on Postman for API validation ahead of UI availability.
- Authored onboarding documentation and accessibility guides that reduced ramp-up time and made new developers productive faster.

Gauntlet Designs, Founder

01/2020 - Present (Freelance)

- Founded a full-stack web studio delivering accessible, production-ready sites for small businesses and nonprofits, leading projects from scope through deployment.
- Designed and built a multi-state employee portal and scheduling platform for a major restaurant franchise, still in active use after five years.
- Established reusable component patterns and documentation across all client projects, reducing inconsistency and improving handoff.

IronClad, UI Developer

01/2022 - 03/2022

- Delivered wireframes and interaction specs that defined the React component architecture for Defense Intelligence Agency web applications.
- Authored accessibility and UI standards adopted as the shared reference for design and engineering alignment.

Global Dimensions, Web Developer

08/2021 - 01/2022

- Built a scroll-driven animated timeline for NGA analyst platforms using Vue, GSAP, and CSS — set as the visual reference standard for the project.
- Translated motion-heavy design specs into accessible, performant components without sacrificing fidelity or performance, including hands-on JAWS screen reader testing during accessibility validation.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Platinum Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2024

Built a convention registration and scheduling platform used by 100+ attendees for session sign-ups and on-site coordination.

Gold Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2023

Prototyped competing design directions for stakeholder review — the selected direction directly influenced a multi-year contract award.

Gold Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2022

Redesigned a high-visibility internal application; improved usability earned recognition from Amazon developers at AWS re:Invent.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

George Washington University, 2020

Web Development Certification

General Assembly, 2022

User Experience Design

CompTIA, 2022

Security+ (Active)

PROJECTS & VOLUNTEER WORK

No Whiteboard Jobs Dashboard - Side Project

no-wb.org

Job search dashboard built on the Hiring Without Whiteboards dataset — full-text search, filtering, pagination, and responsive layouts. Astro, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.

Pretty Pretty Pretty Good - Freelance Studio

prettyprettyprettygood.org/

Access-first freelance studio delivering custom sites for nonprofits and community organizations — free or sliding-scale. Astro, Vercel, Upstash Redis.

JS13K — Electron Orbital Puzzle

github.com/aftongauntlett/js13k-demo

Physics-based puzzle game built under the 13KB JS13k size constraint. Emergent charge mechanics using vanilla JavaScript and Canvas 2D.